

you are new to retail, and are looking to step foot into the eCommerce side of things, let us open your eyes to some ground realities buddy.

Not enough planning:

If earlier lines come remotely close to describing how you feel about online retail, you my friend, are in deep trouble. Business ideas with immense potential have failed miserably due to something as basic as lack of planning. Before you decide to set foot in the world of online retailing, plan your moves. Right from choosing the correct domain name to designing an easy-to-use and easy-to-navigate website, every choice you make will help determine the success rate of your business.

There are a number of fundamental questions you need to ask yourself before you set out on this journey. What is your business goal with selling in the online space? Are you doing this to bring down the costs on the goods or are you doing this because you believe it is where you will get more traffic than an offline brick and mortar store? While you determine this, even set targets for your business - realistic and achievable targets that will help you grow.

The biggest mistake a new business owner stepping into the online space can make is that they believe the costs are low. There are a number of hidden costs that fall into place once you start doing your research. You have to book a domain name, create a website, design it, have a payment gateway integrated, consider the laws and legalities that come with the eCommerce business, invest in security against credit card fraud and other sensitive personal data of your customers, online marketing, offline marketing if any, etc.

Where is the traffic?

When it comes to finding the apt location for a brick and mortar store, things are pretty obvious. For instance, if you are in the business of selling garments for men and women, the most obvious choice of location would be a hustling, bustling mall. A well-known mall in a high-end locality would automatically translate to higher footfalls. When people enter your store and check out your goods, they are indulging in a meaningful interaction with your business. Even if this 'visit' to the store does not end up as a sale, it still means a certain amount of brand recall.

Things are a little different when it comes to the online world. When you set up a store online, imagine it as being a store alongside a long dusty